FOOD DELIVERY APP — PRODUCT TEARDOWN

Overview

This project is a product teardown of a food delivery app, focused on understanding the user experience, identifying key user problems, evaluating the product experience, and proposing practical product improvements.

The goal of this teardown is to demonstrate my ability to think like a Product Manager by combining:

· User research
· Product analysis
· User journey mapping
· Problem identification
· Competitive thinking
· Feature prioritization
· Product improvement recommendations

Objective

The objective of this teardown is to answer the following questions:
1. Who are the primary users of a food delivery app?
2. What problems does the product solve?
3. What are the main user journeys?
4. What works well in the current experience?
5. Where do users experience friction?
6. What are the biggest opportunities for improvement?
7. What features could improve the user experience and business outcomes?
8. How should these opportunities be prioritized?

Product Overview
Product Category
Food Delivery
Product Being Analyzed
Food Delivery App

Core Value Proposition

The product connects customers with restaurants and delivery partners, allowing users to discover food, place orders, make payments, and track deliveries without visiting a restaurant physically.

PRIMARY USERS

1.**Customers**
People who want to:
· Discover restaurants
· Browse menus
· Compare prices
· Order food
· Make payments
· Track deliveries
· Receive food conveniently

2. **Restaurants**

Restaurants use the platform to:
· Reach more customers
· Receive online orders
· Manage menus
· Process orders
· Increase sales
· Reach customers outside their physical location

3. **Delivery Partners**

Delivery riders use the platform to:
· Receive delivery requests
· Pick up orders
· Navigate to customers
· Deliver food
· Earn income

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Ordering food traditionally can involve several inconveniences.
Users may need to:
· Search for restaurants manually
· Call restaurants to place orders
· Wait on phone calls
· Travel to restaurants
· Deal with uncertain delivery times

· Have limited visibility into order status
· Experience difficulty comparing restaurants and prices

A food delivery platform attempts to solve these problems by bringing restaurant discovery, ordering, payment, and delivery tracking into one digital experience.

Target User Persona
Persona: Working professional
Name: Goodgift
Age: 26
Occupation: Office Assistant
Location: Lagos, Nigeria
Lifestyle: Busy working professional

Goals
· Order food quickly
· Find affordable meals
· Discover nearby restaurants
· Know when food will arrive
· Avoid long waiting times
· Make secure payments

Pain Points
· Too many restaurant choices
· Delivery fees can be expensive
· Estimated delivery times may change
· Food may arrive late
· Difficulty knowing whether a restaurant is reliable
· Limited information about portion size
· Poor communication when an order is delayed

Needs
· Fast restaurant discovery
· Accurate delivery estimates
· Transparent pricing
· Reliable order tracking
· Easy reordering
· Clear communication

User Journey

Stage 1 — Need Recognition

The user becomes hungry and decides to order food.

User Action
Open the food delivery app.

User Question
What can I eat right now?

Potential Friction

The user may not know what restaurant or meal to choose.

Stage 2 — Restaurant Discovery
The user searches or browses restaurants.

User Actions
· Searches for food
· Filters restaurants
· Views restaurant ratings
· Checks delivery fees
· Reviews menus

Potential Friction

Too many choices can make decision-making difficult.

Stage 3 — Menu Selection
The user opens a restaurant and reviews its menu.

User Actions
· Views food items
· Checks prices
· Reads descriptions
· Selects meal
· Adds items to cart

Potential Friction

Some menu items may have incomplete descriptions or unclear portion information.

Stage 4 — Checkout

The user reviews the order and proceeds to checkout.

User Actions

· Confirms items
· Enters delivery address
· Selects payment method
· Reviews total price
· Places order

Potential Friction

Unexpected delivery charges or additional fees may cause users to abandon the order.

Stage 5 — Order Confirmation

The restaurant receives the order.

User Expectations

The user wants confirmation that:
· The order was received
· The restaurant accepted it
· Preparation has started
· The estimated delivery time is accurate

Stage 6 — Delivery Tracking

The food is prepared and picked up by a delivery partner.

User Actions

· Tracks order
· Checks estimated arrival time
· Monitors delivery status

Potential Friction

Tracking information may not always accurately reflect the actual delivery progress.

Stage 7 — Delivery

The rider arrives and delivers the food.

User Actions

· Receives order

· Checks food
· Confirms delivery

Stage 8 — Post-Order

The user evaluates the experience.

User Actions

· Rates restaurant
· Rates delivery
· Reviews food
· Reorders
· Contacts support if there is a problem

What Works Well

A food delivery product can provide significant convenience through several core experiences.

Restaurant Discovery

Users can discover multiple restaurants from one platform rather than searching for individual restaurants.

Digital Ordering

Users can place orders without calling or physically visiting restaurants.

Menu Visibility

Users can review available meals and prices before ordering.

Online Payment

Digital payment reduces the need for cash transactions.

Order Tracking

Tracking provides users with visibility into the progress of their order.

Convenience

The overall experience reduces the time and effort required to obtain food.

PAIN POINTS

Pain Point 1 — Delivery Uncertainty
Users may receive an estimated delivery time but experience significant delays.

Impact
This can reduce trust and satisfaction.

Pain Point 2 — Hidden or Unexpected Fees
Additional delivery or service charges can increase the final order price.

Impact
Users may abandon the checkout process.

Pain Point 3 — Restaurant Choice Overload
Having many restaurants available can make it difficult to decide what to order.

Impact
Users may spend too much time browsing.

Pain Point 4 — Inaccurate Food Information
Some restaurants may provide limited information about:

· Ingredients
· Portion sizes
· Food images
· Allergens
· Preparation times

Impact
Users may make decisions with incomplete information.

Pain Point 5 — Poor Communication During Delays
Users may not receive sufficient information when an order is delayed.

Impact
Uncertainty can create frustration and increase support requests.

PRODUCT OPPORTUNITIES

Based on the identified pain points, several opportunities could improve the product experience.

Opportunity 1 — More Accurate Delivery Estimates.

Use historical delivery data, restaurant preparation times, rider availability, traffic conditions, and location data to improve estimated delivery times.

Expected Benefit
· Better user expectations
· Increased trust
· Fewer complaints

Opportunity 2 — Transparent Pricing
Display the complete order cost before checkout.
Example
Instead of showing:
Food: ₦5,000
Show:
· Food: ₦5,000
· Delivery: ₦800
· Service fee: ₦300
· Total: ₦6,100

Expected Benefit
Users understand the actual cost before placing the order.

Opportunity 3 — Personalized Food Recommendations.

Recommend meals based on:
· Previous orders
· Favorite restaurants
· Time of day
· Location
· Cuisine preferences
· Frequently ordered meals

Expected Benefit
Reduce the time users spend deciding what to order.

Opportunity 4 — Delay Notifications.
Automatically notify users when an order is delayed.

Example
"Your order is taking longer than expected. The restaurant needs an additional 15 minutes to prepare your meal."

Expected Benefit
Users receive information instead of having to contact support.

Opportunity 5 — Better Restaurant Information.
Standardize restaurant information across the platform.
Information could include:
· Food images
· Portion size
· Ingredients
· Preparation time
· Restaurant rating
· Number of completed orders
· Delivery estimate

Expected Benefit
Users can make more informed decisions.

FEATURE RECOMMENDATIONS
Feature 1 — Smart Delivery ETA

Problem
Delivery estimates may not always reflect actual delivery conditions.

Proposed Solution
Create a dynamic ETA system that continuously updates delivery estimates using:
· Restaurant preparation time
· Rider location
· Traffic conditions
· Distance
· Historical delivery data

Success Metrics
· ETA accuracy
· On-time delivery rate
· Delivery-related complaints
· Customer satisfaction

Feature 2 — "Order Again" Shortcut

Problem
Users frequently reorder meals they already like.

Proposed Solution.
Add an easily accessible Order Again section showing previous orders.

Example:
Order Again
· Chicken & Rice — ₦5,500
· Jollof Rice & Chicken — ₦4,800
· Burger & Fries — ₦6,000

Success Metrics
· Reorder rate
· Repeat purchase frequency
· Time to checkout
· Conversion rate

Feature 3 — Delivery Delay Alerts
Problem
Users become frustrated when their order is delayed without explanation.

Proposed Solution.
Automatically send notifications when delivery status changes significantly.

Example
"Your order is delayed by approximately 15 minutes due to restaurant preparation time."

Success Metrics
· Delivery-related support contacts
· Customer satisfaction
· Cancellation rate
· Complaint rate

Feature 4 — Smart Food Recommendations

Problem

Users may spend too much time deciding what to order.

Proposed Solution.
Create a personalized recommendation section based on user behavior.

Example:
Recommended for You

· Your usual Jollof Rice
· Popular near you
· Your favorite restaurant
· Under ₦5,000
· Fast delivery

Success Metrics
· Recommendation click-through rate
· Conversion rate
· Average order value
· Orders per user

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS
Food delivery products can be compared across several dimensions.

Criteria| Product A| Product B| Product C
Restaurant Discovery| Strong| Strong| Medium
Search & Filters| Strong| Medium| Strong
Menu Information| Medium| Strong| Medium
Delivery Tracking| Strong| Strong| Medium
Price Transparency| Medium| Medium| Strong
Personalization| Medium| Strong| Medium
Reordering| Strong| Medium| Strong
Customer Support| Medium| Strong| Medium

Note: Replace Product A, Product B, and Product C with the actual competitors you research.

PRIORITIZATION
I would prioritize the proposed opportunities using a simple Impact vs Effort framework.

High Impact / Lower Effort
· Delivery delay notifications
· Order Again shortcut
· Transparent pricing improvements

High Impact / Higher Effort
· Smart delivery ETA
· Personalized recommendations

Lower Impact / Lower Effort
· Additional menu information
· UI improvements

Lower Impact / Higher Effort
· Advanced personalization infrastructure
· Complex recommendation systems

RECOMMENDED MVP
If I were working on this product, I would start with a small MVP focused on improving trust and reducing friction.

MVP Features
1. Transparent checkout pricing
2. Delivery delay notifications
3. Order Again shortcut
4. Improved delivery status updates

Why These Features?
These improvements address common user frustrations without requiring a complete redesign of the food delivery experience.

SUCCESS METRICS

The product improvements should be measured using both user and business metrics.

North Star Metric
Completed food orders per active customer

This metric reflects whether users are successfully discovering, ordering, and receiving food through the platform.

Supporting Metrics
Acquisition
· New users
· Signup conversion rate
· Cost per acquisition

Activation
· First restaurant viewed
· First cart created
· First order completed

Engagement
· Orders per user
· Sessions per user
· Restaurant views
· Search usage

Conversion
· Restaurant-to-cart conversion
· Cart-to-checkout conversion
· Checkout-to-order conversion

Retention
· Repeat order rate
· 30-day retention
· 90-day retention

Customer Experience
· Customer satisfaction
· NPS
· Cancellation rate
· Complaint rate
· Support contact rate

Delivery
· On-time delivery rate
· Average delivery time
· ETA accuracy

PRODUCT HYPOTHESES

Hypothesis 1

If delivery estimates become more accurate, users will have greater confidence in the platform and delivery-related complaints will decrease.

Hypothesis 2

If users can quickly reorder previous meals, repeat purchases will increase.

Hypothesis 3

If users receive proactive delay notifications, support requests related to delayed orders will decrease.

Hypothesis 4

If the checkout process clearly displays the complete order cost, checkout abandonment caused by unexpected fees will decrease.

Experiment Ideas

Experiment 1 — Delivery Delay Notifications

Control
Users receive standard order-status notifications.

Variant
Users receive proactive notifications explaining significant delays.

Measure
Compare:

· Cancellation rate
· Support contacts
· Customer satisfaction
· Completed orders

Experiment 2 — Order Again

Control
Users manually search for previously ordered meals.

Variant
Users see an "Order Again" section on the home screen.

Measure
Compare:
· Repeat order rate
· Time to checkout
· Conversion rate

User Research Questions

To validate the identified problems, I would interview food delivery users.

General Questions
1. How often do you order food online?
2. Which food delivery apps do you use?
3. What usually makes you choose one app over another?
4. What is the most important factor when choosing a restaurant?
5. How long do you normally spend deciding what to order?

Ordering Questions
1. What makes you abandon an order?
2. Have you ever experienced unexpected fees?
3. How important is delivery time when choosing a restaurant?
4. Have you experienced a significantly delayed order?
5. How did you respond?

Delivery Questions
1. How accurate are delivery estimates in your experience?
2. What information would you like to receive while waiting?
3. What would make you trust the delivery estimate more?

Post-Order Questions
1. How often do you reorder the same meal?
2. What makes you want to return to a restaurant?
3. What makes you stop ordering from a restaurant?
4. What would you improve about your food delivery experience?

Key Product Insights

Based on this teardown, several important product insights emerge:

Insight 1
Food delivery is not only about discovering food; it is also about reducing uncertainty throughout the ordering and delivery journey.

Insight 2
Delivery reliability and transparent pricing can directly influence user trust.

Insight 3
Personalization can reduce decision-making effort for frequent users.

Insight 4

Proactive communication can improve the experience when something goes wrong.

Insight 5
Small improvements to repeat-order flows can reduce friction for existing users.

Final Product Recommendation

The product should focus on reducing uncertainty and friction across the customer journey.
The most important areas to investigate further are:
1. Delivery ETA accuracy
2. Price transparency
3. Delivery communication
4. Restaurant information quality
5. Reordering
6. Personalized recommendations

These areas should be validated through user research and product experiments before significant engineering investment.

Product Management Skills Demonstrated

This project demonstrates practical understanding of:
· Product Discovery
· User Research
· User Personas
· User Journey Mapping
· Problem Identification
· Product Analysis
· Competitive Analysis
· Feature Ideation
· Feature Prioritization
· MVP Definition
· Product Metrics
· Product Hypotheses
· A/B Testing
· Experiment Design
· Product Strategy

Tools

· Google Docs
· Google Sheets

· GitHub
· ChatGPT

About The Author
Ubong Bassey
I'm a certified Product Manager with experience and practical knowledge across Product Research, User Research, Market Research, Competitive Analysis, Content Strategy, Community Management, and Digital Operations.

I am building practical product case studies to demonstrate my ability to research problems, understand users, analyze products, identify opportunities, and propose data-informed product improvements.

Disclaimer

This is an independent product teardown created for educational and portfolio purposes.
The analysis represents my own observations and hypotheses and is not affiliated with or endorsed by any food delivery company discussed in this project.